VENVLEARNING

TEACHER EDITION



Social Studies

GRADE 4

Guided lessons, pacing, and complete answer keys

2 units

VENVLEARNING

Grade 4
Social Studies

TEACHER EDITION

Unit 1 Mississippi: Land and Regions

Unit 2 Mississippi's People: Past and Present

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this Teacher Edition

This book holds everything needed to teach the course: unit overviews, a plan for every lesson with what to say and do, the student lesson with Try It answers, and answer keys for every workbook page, weekly check and unit test.

- Daily routine (about 45–55 minutes): Warm-Up 5 · Read and Discuss 15 · Analyze 10 · Guided Practice 7 · Independent 10 · Exit Ticket 3.
- Say: lines are a suggested script. Use your own words.
- Two lessons a week, then the Weekly Check (about 15 minutes), then corrections or a project.
- Each plan's Pacing row and each unit's pacing guide give the week and lesson order. Set the days to fit your own calendar.

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UNIT 1 · TEACHER OVERVIEW

Mississippi: Land and Regions

Map skills, location, landforms and rivers, natural regions, resources, and regional economies.

From the flat, fertile Delta to the pine forests and the Gulf Coast, Mississippi is a state of many landscapes. In this unit you'll learn to read maps like a geographer, find Mississippi's place in the world, explore its rivers and regions, and discover how its natural resources shape the way people live and work.

Big ideas

- Read maps using the title, compass rose, key, and scale.
- Describe Mississippi's relative and absolute location.
- Identify landforms, waterways, and natural regions.
- Classify natural resources and explain how they shape regional economies.

Standards

Code	Standard
C3 D2.Geo.1–4	Maps; places and regions; human–environment interaction.
C3 D2.Eco.3	Resources used to produce goods and services.

What students should already know

- Cardinal directions.

Materials for the unit

- Globe or world map
- Mississippi road map (optional)
- Salt dough materials
- Index cards, poster paper

Pacing guide

Teach the lessons in order, then give the week's check. Set the days to fit your own calendar.

Week	Order	Lesson	Title
Week 1	Lesson 1 of 2	1.1	Maps and Globes
Week 1	Lesson 2 of 2	1.2	Where in the World Is Mississippi?
Week 1	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 1: Maps and Location
Week 2	Lesson 1 of 2	1.3	Mississippi's Land and Water
Week 2	Lesson 2 of 2	1.4	Reading Physical and Political Maps
Week 2	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 2: Land and Water
Week 3	Lesson 1 of 2	1.5	Mississippi's Natural Regions
Week 3	Lesson 2 of 2	1.6	Comparing the Delta and the Piney Woods
Week 3	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 3: Regions
Week 4	Lesson 1 of 2	1.7	Natural Resources
Week 4	Lesson 2 of 2	1.8	Resources and Work in Each Region
Week 4	Before the test	Review	Unit 1 Review
Week 4	End of unit	Test	Unit 1 Test

TEACHING THIS UNIT AT HOME

On your next drive, look at a map together before you leave and track your route, directions, and the rivers you cross.

UNIT VOCABULARY

compass rose	Shows directions on a map.
latitude	Lines measuring distance north or south of the equator.
region	An area with shared features.
natural resource	Something from nature people use.
goods	Things made or grown to sell.
services	Work done for others.

LESSON 1.1 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 1 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.1: Maps and Globes

Student goal	I can use a map's title, compass rose, key, and scale to read a map.
Objective	Students use map parts to read a map.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.1.3-5 — Construct maps and other representations of familiar places.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 1, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 1.1, paper, ruler, colored pencils
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Directions to a park.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and the Mississippi map.
Analyze	10	Model each map part. Measure Jackson to Gulfport with the scale.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Assuming north is always “up” on every map without checking the compass rose.

SUPPORT

- Map-part sticky labels.

EXTEND

- Map your neighborhood.

STUDENT LESSON 1.1 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.1: Maps and Globes

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.1 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Map My Room.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.1 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

If you had to give a friend directions from your house to a park, what would you draw?

A globe is a model of Earth, so it shows shapes and distances correctly, but it's hard to carry and you can only see half at a time. A map is a flat drawing of a place. Maps can show a whole country or one small neighborhood.

Map part	What it tells you
title	what the map shows
compass rose	directions: north (N), south (S), east (E), west (W), and in-between directions like northeast (NE)
map key (legend)	what each symbol, line, or color means
scale	how far apart places really are

This map's title tells you it shows cities of Mississippi. The star marks Jackson, the state capital, and dots mark other cities.

The compass rose in the top corner points north. The scale bar at the bottom stands for 50 miles. Rivers are drawn in blue.

Notice that the Mississippi River traces most of the state's western edge, and the southern coast meets the Gulf of Mexico.

Cities of Mississippi



LOOK CLOSER · USE THE SCALE

About how far is it from Jackson to Gulfport?

1 Measure the distance on the map with a strip of paper.

2 Compare it with the scale bar (50 miles).

3 The distance is about three scale bars long.

Answer: about 150 miles

ACTIVITY · MAP MY ROOM

Can you make a map someone else could use?

You need: paper; ruler; colored pencils.

1 Draw your bedroom or kitchen as if you were looking down from the ceiling.

2 Add a title and a compass rose (find north with a compass app or the sunrise in the east).

3 Make a key with at least four symbols.

4 Add a scale such as “1 inch = 2 feet.”

Record: your finished map; trade with a family member and ask them to find something using only the map.

★ KEY IDEA

Read the title, check the compass rose, use the key, and measure with the scale.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Which map part explains symbols?

Answer: the map key (legend)

2. Which direction is between north and east?

Answer: northeast

3. Which city is the state capital?

Answer: Jackson

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.1

#	Question	Answer
1	Which map part explains symbols?	the map key (legend)
2	Which direction is between north and east?	northeast
3	Which city is the state capital?	Jackson
4	The four cardinal directions	north, south, east, west
5	A round model of Earth	globe
6	Use the map for questions 3–7. Which city is farthest north? (figure)	Southaven
7	Which two cities are on the Gulf of Mexico?	Gulfport and Biloxi
8	In which direction would you travel from Jackson to Meridian?	east
9	In which direction from Tupelo is Hattiesburg?	south (slightly southwest)
10	Which river forms Mississippi's western border?	the Mississippi River
11	Name the four map parts and tell what each one does.	Title: what the map shows; compass rose: directions; key: symbols; scale: distance.

LESSON 1.2 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 1 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.2: Where in the World Is Mississippi?

Student goal	I can describe Mississippi's location using relative location, hemispheres, and latitude and longitude.
Objective	Students describe relative and absolute location.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 — Use maps to explain relationships between locations of places.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 1, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Globe or world map, workbook Lesson 1.2
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Describe home to someone far away.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; examine both maps.
Analyze	10	Teach latitude/longitude and hemispheres.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Mixing up latitude and longitude.

SUPPORT

- "Lat is flat" memory trick.

EXTEND

- Find the coordinates of a favorite vacation spot.

STUDENT LESSON 1.2 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.2: Where in the World Is Mississippi?

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.2 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Grid Hunt.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.2 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

How would you describe where you live to someone on the other side of the world?

Relative location describes a place by what is near it. Mississippi is in the southern United States. It borders Tennessee to the north, Alabama to the east, the Gulf of Mexico and Louisiana to the south, and Louisiana and Arkansas to the west, across the Mississippi River.



Mississippi is highlighted.

Absolute location uses a grid of imaginary lines. Lines of latitude measure degrees north or south of the equator. Lines of longitude measure degrees east or west of the prime meridian.

Because Mississippi is north of the equator and west of the prime meridian, it is in the Northern and Western Hemispheres. Jackson is at about 32° N, 90° W.



Latitude labels at left; longitude labels at bottom.

ACTIVITY · GRID HUNT

Can you find places using latitude and longitude?

You need: a globe or world map with latitude and longitude lines; paper and a pencil.

1 Find 30° N, 90° W. What place is near there?

2 Find the equator and the prime meridian.

3 Find a place in each of the four hemispheres.

4 Make up two coordinates and challenge a family member to find them.

Record: each coordinate and the place you found.

★ KEY IDEA

Relative location compares places; absolute location uses latitude and longitude. Mississippi is in the Northern and Western Hemispheres.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Which state borders Mississippi to the east?

Answer: Alabama

2. Which body of water is south of Mississippi?

Answer: the Gulf of Mexico

3. Which hemispheres is Mississippi in?

Answer: Northern and Western

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.2

#	Question	Answer
1	Which state borders Mississippi to the east?	Alabama
2	Which body of water is south of Mississippi?	the Gulf of Mexico
3	Which hemispheres is Mississippi in?	Northern and Western
4	Lines that run east–west	latitude
5	Half of Earth is a...	hemisphere
6	State north of Mississippi	Tennessee
7	Two states west of Mississippi	Louisiana and Arkansas
8	Jackson's approximate latitude	32° N
9	Is Mississippi north or south of the equator?	north
10	Relative or absolute: “Jackson is about 32° N, 90° W.”	absolute
11	Relative or absolute: “Gulfport is on the Gulf of Mexico.”	relative
12	Describe Mississippi's relative location in two sentences.	e.g. Mississippi is in the southern U.S. between Louisiana and Alabama, with Tennessee to the north and the Gulf of Mexico to the south.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 1.2

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 1: Maps and Location — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Which map part shows directions?	compass rose
2	Which map part explains symbols?	map key (legend)
3	What does a scale show?	real distance
4	Which state is east of Mississippi?	Alabama
5	Which hemispheres is Mississippi in?	Northern and Western
6	Relative or absolute: “32° N, 90° W”	absolute

LESSON 1.3 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 2 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.3: Mississippi's Land and Water

Student goal	I can identify Mississippi's major landforms and waterways and explain why they matter.
Objective	Students identify landforms and waterways.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 — Use maps to explain relationships between places and environmental characteristics.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 2, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Tray, towel, water, pebbles, workbook Lesson 1.3
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Rivers flow south.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; trace rivers on the map.
Analyze	10	Discuss elevation and flow; waterways and trade.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking rivers always flow “down” the map (south) everywhere.

SUPPORT

- Highlight each river a different color.

EXTEND

- Research a Mississippi river's source.

STUDENT LESSON 1.3 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.3: Mississippi's Land and Water

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.3 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Which Way Does Water Flow?.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.3 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

Most of Mississippi's rivers flow toward the south. Why do you think that is?

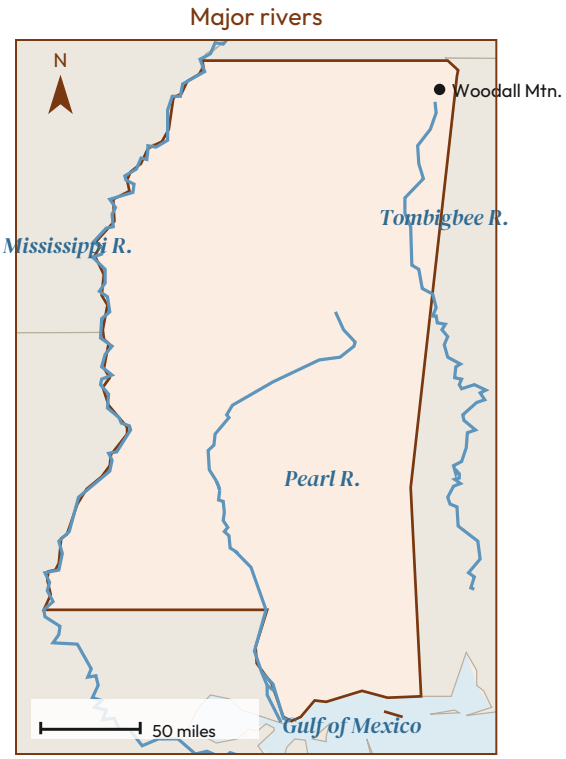
Mississippi is mostly low, rolling hills and flat plains. Its highest point is Woodall Mountain in the far northeast, about 806 feet above sea level. Its lowest point is sea level along the Gulf of Mexico. Because the land is generally higher in the north and lower in the south, most rivers flow south toward the Gulf.

Waterway	Fact
Mississippi River	Forms most of the state's western border; one of the longest rivers in North America
Yazoo River	Flows through the Delta into the Mississippi at Vicksburg
Pearl River	Flows past Jackson to the Gulf; part of it forms the border with Louisiana
Tombigbee River	Flows south through eastern Mississippi into Alabama
Pascagoula River	Flows into the Gulf at Pascagoula
Gulf of Mexico	Mississippi's southern coast, about 44 miles long

Waterways have always mattered to people here. Rivers provided fish, water, and travel routes for American Indian nations.

Later, steamboats carried cotton and goods on the Mississippi River.

Today, barges still move goods on the Mississippi and on the Tennessee-Tombigbee Waterway, a canal system opened in 1985 that connects the Tennessee River to the Tombigbee.



ACTIVITY · WHICH WAY DOES WATER FLOW?

How does the slope of land decide where rivers go?

You need: a baking sheet or tray; a towel to tilt it; a cup of water; a few pebbles.

1. Raise one end of the tray to make “high land” in the north.
2. Slowly pour water at the high end.
3. Watch which way it flows and where it collects.
4. Add pebbles as “hills” and observe how the water's path changes.

Record: a sketch showing high land, low land, and the water's path, and an explanation linked to Mississippi's rivers.

★ KEY IDEA

Mississippi's land is higher in the north and lower in the south, so most rivers flow south to the Gulf. Rivers have shaped travel, trade, and settlement.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. What is Mississippi's highest point?

Answer: Woodall Mountain (about 806 feet)

2. Which river forms most of the western border?

Answer: the Mississippi River

3. Why do most rivers flow south?

Answer: The land is higher in the north and lower in the south.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.3

#	Question	Answer
1	What is Mississippi's highest point?	Woodall Mountain (about 806 feet)
2	Which river forms most of the western border?	the Mississippi River
3	Why do most rivers flow south?	The land is higher in the north and lower in the south.
4	A large area of flat land	plain
5	A smaller river that flows into a larger one	tributary
6	Which river flows past Jackson?	the Pearl River
7	Where does the Yazoo River join the Mississippi?	at Vicksburg
8	What canal system connects the Tennessee and Tombigbee rivers?	the Tennessee-Tombigbee Waterway
9	What is Mississippi's lowest elevation?	sea level
10	Explain two ways rivers have been important to people in Mississippi.	e.g. fish and water; travel and trade by boat and barge.
11	Use the tray investigation to explain why the Pearl River flows to the Gulf.	Water flows downhill; the land slopes down toward the Gulf in the south.

LESSON 1.4 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 2 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.4: Reading Physical and Political Maps

Student goal	I can tell physical and political maps apart and use each to answer questions.
Objective	Students compare physical and political maps.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.1.3-5 — Construct maps and other graphic representations.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 2, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Salt dough materials, workbook Lesson 1.4
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Rivers vs cities.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; compare the maps.
Analyze	10	Model using two maps together.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking one map shows everything.

SUPPORT

- Sort questions into physical/political.

EXTEND

- Find your county on a Mississippi county map.

STUDENT LESSON 1.4 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.4: Reading Physical and Political Maps

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.4 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Salt Dough Relief Map.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.4 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

What's the difference between a map of the rivers in Mississippi and a map of its cities?

A physical map shows what nature made: rivers, hills, coastlines, and elevation, often with colors (green for low land, tan or brown for higher land). A political map shows what people decided: state and county boundaries, capitals, and cities. Mississippi is divided into 82 counties.

Question	Better map
Where is the state capital?	political
Where is the land highest?	physical
Which county is Tupelo in?	political
Which way does the Pearl River flow?	physical

LOOK CLOSER · USE TWO MAPS TOGETHER

Why did cities like Vicksburg and Natchez grow where they did?

1 Physical map: both sit on high bluffs beside the Mississippi River.

2 Political map: both are cities in western Mississippi.

3 Put them together: the high bluffs were safe from floods, and the river brought trade.

Answer: They grew on bluffs above the river, where people could trade by boat but stay above floodwaters.

ACTIVITY · SALT DOUGH RELIEF MAP

Can you build a physical map of Mississippi?

You need: outline of Mississippi traced on cardboard; salt dough (2 cups flour, 1 cup salt, about 3/4 cup water); paint; toothpick flags.

1. Spread a thin layer of dough over the outline.
2. Build it a little higher in the northeast and keep the Delta and coast flat.
3. Press a groove for the Mississippi and Pearl rivers.
4. When dry, paint low land green and higher land tan, and add flags for Jackson and your town.

Record: a photo or sketch of your map with a key.

★ KEY IDEA

Physical maps show natural features; political maps show boundaries and cities. Using both explains why places are where they are.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Which kind of map shows county lines?

Answer: political

2. Which kind shows elevation?

Answer: physical

3. How many counties does Mississippi have?

Answer: 82

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.4

#	Question	Answer
1	Which kind of map shows county lines?	political
2	Which kind shows elevation?	physical
3	How many counties does Mississippi have?	82
4	Height above sea level	elevation
5	Map that shows cities	political map
6	Find the route of the Yazoo River. Which map?	physical
7	Find the boundary between Mississippi and Alabama. Which map?	political
8	Find the flattest region. Which map?	physical
9	Find the nearest city to your home. Which map?	political

#	Question	Answer
10	Why might a city grow on a bluff next to a river?	Safe from floods but close to the river for water and trade.
11	Write one question a physical map can answer and one a political map can answer.	Answers vary.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 1.4

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 2: Land and Water — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Mississippi's highest point	Woodall Mountain
2	River on the western border	Mississippi River
3	River that flows past Jackson	Pearl River
4	Map that shows elevation	physical
5	Map that shows county lines	political
6	Why do most Mississippi rivers flow south?	The land is higher in the north and slopes down to the Gulf.

LESSON 1.5 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 3 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.5: Mississippi's Natural Regions

Student goal	I can identify Mississippi's natural regions and describe the land in each.
Objective	Students identify Mississippi's natural regions.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.2.3-5 — Explain relationships between locations of places and regions and their environmental characteristics.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 3, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Index cards, workbook Lesson 1.5
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Road trip changes.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; locate regions on the map.
Analyze	10	Discuss each region's land and soil.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking regions have sharp borders.

SUPPORT

- Color-coded region chart.

EXTEND

- Find photos of each region.

STUDENT LESSON 1.5 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.5: Mississippi's Natural Regions

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.5 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Region Postcards.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.5 (Parts B–D).

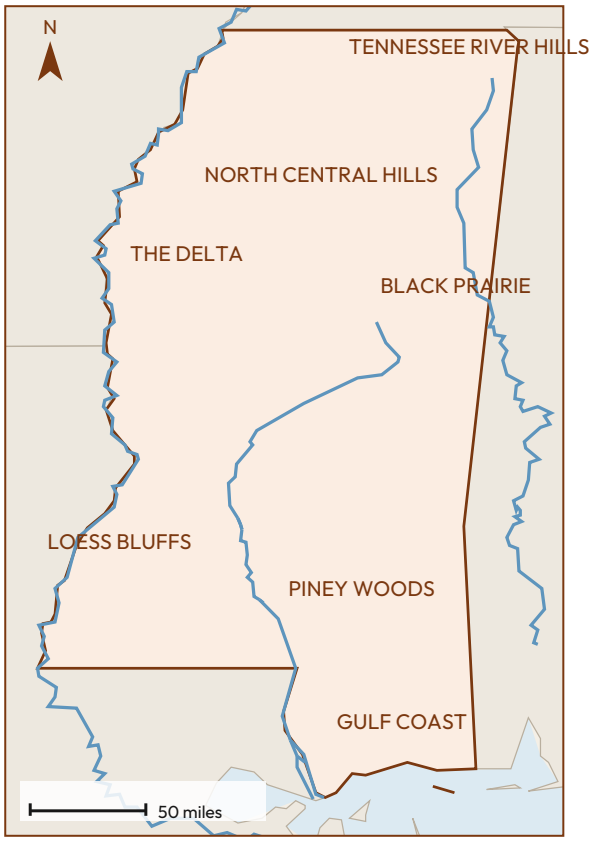
THINK ABOUT IT

If you drove from Tupelo to Greenville to Gulfport, how might the land outside your window change?

Geographers divide Mississippi into natural regions by land, soil, and plants.

Regions don't have sharp edges; one blends into the next. The labels on the map show where each region generally is.

As you read the chart below, find each region on the map.



General locations of Mississippi's natural regions.

Region	What the land is like
The Delta	very flat, fertile alluvial soil left by Mississippi and Yazoo river floods; northwest
Loess Bluffs	steep bluffs of fine wind-blown soil along the east edge of the Mississippi River valley
North Central Hills	rolling hills with red clay soil
Tennessee River Hills	the highest, most rugged land, in the far northeast
Black Prairie	gently rolling land with dark, rich soil in the northeast
Piney Woods	rolling hills with sandy soil and pine forests in the south
Gulf Coast	low, flat land with beaches, marshes, and bays along the Gulf of Mexico

ACTIVITY · REGION POSTCARDS

What would you see in each region?

You need: index cards; colored pencils.

1 Choose three regions.

2 On each card, draw a scene showing the land, plants, and one way people use the land.

3 On the back, write a short message describing the region to a friend.

Record: three postcards with accurate details.

★ KEY IDEA

Mississippi's regions include the Delta, Loess Bluffs, the hills, the Black Prairie, the Piney Woods, and the Gulf Coast, each with its own land and soil.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Which region is flattest and most fertile?

Answer: the Delta

2. Which region has pine forests?

Answer: the Piney Woods

3. Which region has the highest land?

Answer: the Tennessee River Hills

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.5

#	Question	Answer
1	Which region is flattest and most fertile?	the Delta
2	Which region has pine forests?	the Piney Woods
3	Which region has the highest land?	the Tennessee River Hills
4	Region =	an area with shared features
5	Soil left by rivers is...	alluvial
6	beaches and marshes	Gulf Coast
7	dark, rich soil in the northeast	Black Prairie
8	wind-blown soil bluffs	Loess Bluffs
9	red clay hills	North Central Hills
10	flat land between two rivers	the Delta
11	sandy soil and pines	Piney Woods
12	Which region do you live in or nearest to? Describe its land.	Answers vary.

LESSON 1.6 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 3 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.6: Comparing the Delta and the Piney Woods

Student goal	I can compare two regions and explain how land affects the way people live and work.
Objective	Students compare two regions.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.4.3-5 — Explain how people modify and adapt to their environments.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 3, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 1.6
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Delta farm vs Piney Woods town.
Read and Discuss	15	Read both descriptions.
Analyze	10	Model one Venn entry each.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Listing facts without comparing.

SUPPORT

- Compare/contrast word bank.

EXTEND

- Interview a relative who lived in another region.

STUDENT LESSON 1.6 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.6: Comparing the Delta and the Piney Woods

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.6 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Venn Diagram.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.6 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

How might growing up on a Delta farm be different from growing up in a Piney Woods town?

The Delta is a broad, flat plain in northwestern Mississippi between the Mississippi and Yazoo rivers. For thousands of years, floods left layers of rich soil. Today the Delta is known for large farms of cotton, soybeans, corn, and rice, and for catfish farming in ponds. Towns are spread out across wide fields. The Delta is also famous as a birthplace of the blues.

The Piney Woods covers much of southeastern Mississippi. Its sandy soil is less fertile for crops, but it is excellent for growing pine trees. Lumber and paper mills grew up around cities such as Hattiesburg and Laurel. Forests here also support hunting, outdoor recreation, and wildlife.

	The Delta	Piney Woods	Both
land	very flat	rolling hills	part of Mississippi; rivers
soil	rich alluvial soil	sandy soil	
main uses	row crops, catfish farms	timber, paper, outdoor recreation	agriculture is important
places	Greenville, Clarksdale	Hattiesburg, Laurel	

ACTIVITY · VENN DIAGRAM

How are the two regions alike and different?

You need: paper; two colored pencils.

1. Draw two overlapping circles labeled Delta and Piney Woods.
2. Write at least four details in each outer part.
3. Write at least two shared details in the middle.

4 Write a summary sentence.

Record: your Venn diagram and summary.

★ KEY IDEA

The land and soil of a region shape how people earn a living there.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Why is the Delta good for crops?

Answer: Floods left rich alluvial soil on flat land.

2. What grows well in the Piney Woods?

Answer: pine trees (timber)

3. Name a Piney Woods city.

Answer: Hattiesburg or Laurel

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.6

#	Question	Answer
1	Why is the Delta good for crops?	Floods left rich alluvial soil on flat land.
2	What grows well in the Piney Woods?	pine trees (timber)
3	Name a Piney Woods city.	Hattiesburg or Laurel
4	To tell how things differ	contrast
5	Trees cut for wood	timber
6	Delta land shape	flat
7	Piney Woods soil	sandy
8	One Delta product	cotton, soybeans, rice, corn, or catfish
9	One Piney Woods product	lumber or paper
10	Write a paragraph comparing the two regions. Use a compare word (both, similarly) and a contrast word (however, but).	Answers vary; include land, soil, and work.
11	Explain how soil affects the jobs people have in each region.	Rich Delta soil supports crops; sandy Piney Woods soil supports pine forests and timber.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 1.6

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 3: Regions — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Flat region with rich river soil	the Delta
2	Region with sandy soil and pine forests	Piney Woods
3	Region with beaches and marshes	Gulf Coast
4	Region with dark, rich soil in the northeast	Black Prairie
5	Name one way the Delta and Piney Woods are alike and one way they are different.	Alike: both are Mississippi regions where natural resources support work. Different: Delta is flat with rich soil for crops; Piney Woods has sandy soil and pine forests.

LESSON 1.7 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 4 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.7: Natural Resources

Student goal	I can identify Mississippi's natural resources and classify them as renewable or nonrenewable.
Objective	Students classify natural resources.
Standard	C3 D2.Eco.3.3-5 — Identify resources used to produce goods and services.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 4, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 1.7
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Room scan.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and table.
Analyze	10	Model classifying resources.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking renewable means unlimited.

SUPPORT

- Picture sort.

EXTEND

- Visit a recycling center or tree farm.

STUDENT LESSON 1.7 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.7: Natural Resources

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.7 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Resource Hunt.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.7 (Parts B–E).

THINK ABOUT IT

Look around the room. What came from nature: from soil, trees, water, or underground?

Mississippi is rich in natural resources. Some are renewable: forests can be replanted, and fish and farm crops can grow again if they are managed well. Others are nonrenewable: oil and natural gas, found underground in parts of southern Mississippi and offshore in the Gulf, took millions of years to form.

Resource	Renewable?	Used for
fertile soil	renewable if cared for	growing crops
forests	renewable (replanting)	lumber, paper, furniture
water (rivers, groundwater)	renewable	drinking, farming, fishing, transportation
fish and shellfish (Gulf)	renewable if not overfished	food
oil and natural gas	nonrenewable	fuel, energy
sand, gravel, and clay	nonrenewable	building roads and bricks

Conservation helps resources last. Foresters replant trees after harvests, farmers protect soil from erosion, and fishing seasons and limits help keep Gulf fish and shrimp populations healthy.

ACTIVITY · RESOURCE HUNT

Where do the things in your home come from?

You need: paper and a pencil.

1 Find ten objects in your home.

2 For each, name the natural resource it came from (wood, cotton, oil/plastic, metal, sand/glass).

3 Label each resource renewable or nonrenewable.

4 Circle one item you could reuse or recycle.

Record: a three-column chart: Object | Natural resource | Renewable or nonrenewable.

★ KEY IDEA

Natural resources come from nature. Renewable resources can be replaced; nonrenewable ones cannot. Conservation helps them last.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Is a pine forest renewable or nonrenewable?

Answer: renewable

2. Is natural gas renewable?

Answer: no, nonrenewable

3. Name one way to conserve a resource.

Answer: e.g. replant trees, recycle, fishing limits

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.7

#	Question	Answer
1	Is a pine forest renewable or nonrenewable?	renewable
2	Is natural gas renewable?	no, nonrenewable
3	Name one way to conserve a resource.	e.g. replant trees, recycle, fishing limits
4	Something from nature people use	natural resource
5	Careful use of resources	conservation
6	cotton	renewable
7	oil	nonrenewable
8	shrimp	renewable (if managed)
9	gravel	nonrenewable
10	water	renewable
11	timber	renewable

#	Question	Answer
12	Choose one Mississippi resource. Explain how people use it and one way to conserve it.	Answers vary.
13	Why is it important to conserve even renewable resources?	They can run out if used faster than they are replaced.

LESSON 1.8 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 4 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: Mississippi: Land and Regions

Lesson 1.8: Resources and Work in Each Region

Student goal	I can explain how natural resources shape the goods, services, and jobs in different regions.
Objective	Students connect resources to regional economies.
Standard	C3 D2.Eco.3.3-5, D2.Geo.4.3-5 — Identify resources used to produce goods and services; how people adapt to environments.
Pacing	Unit 1, week 4, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Poster paper, markers, workbook Lesson 1.8, Unit 1 Review
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Three workers.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and table.
Analyze	10	Model tracing a product.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook; then the Unit 1 Review.
Exit Ticket	3	Next: Unit 1 Test.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Confusing goods and services.

SUPPORT

- Goods = hold it; services = someone does it.

EXTEND

- Visit a local farm, mill, or port online.

STUDENT LESSON 1.8 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.8: Resources and Work in Each Region

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.8 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Regional Economy Poster.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.8 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

A Delta farmer, a Piney Woods mill worker, and a Gulf Coast shrimper all earn a living. What does each one depend on?

The economy of each region grows from its resources. Farmers grow goods in fertile soil. Mill workers turn trees into lumber and paper. Gulf Coast workers catch seafood, build ships, and serve visitors. Agriculture is Mississippi's largest industry, and chickens raised for meat (broilers) are among its most valuable farm products.

Region	Key resources	Goods and services
The Delta	rich soil, water	cotton, soybeans, rice, corn, farm-raised catfish
Piney Woods	pine forests	lumber, paper, wood products
Black Prairie and hills	soil, pasture	cattle, poultry, crops, manufacturing
Gulf Coast	the Gulf, beaches, ports	seafood, shipbuilding, shipping, tourism

LOOK CLOSER · TRACE A PRODUCT

A pine tree becomes a notebook

1. Natural resource: a pine tree grows in the Piney Woods.
2. Producers: loggers harvest it; a paper mill turns it into paper.
3. Services: truck drivers deliver it; a store sells it.
4. Consumer: you buy the notebook.

Answer: One resource creates many jobs on its way to you.

ACTIVITY · REGIONAL ECONOMY POSTER

How does one region earn a living?

You need: poster paper; markers.

1 Choose one region.

2 Show its resources, two goods or services, and two jobs.

3 Draw arrows from each resource to the goods it produces.

4 Present your poster to your family.

Record: your poster and a two-sentence summary.

★ KEY IDEA

Natural resources shape the goods, services, and jobs in each region.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Goods or service: a haircut

Answer: service

2. Goods or service: a bag of rice

Answer: goods

3. Which region is known for shipbuilding and seafood?

Answer: the Gulf Coast

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.8

#	Question	Answer
1	Goods or service: a haircut	service
2	Goods or service: a bag of rice	goods
3	Which region is known for shipbuilding and seafood?	the Gulf Coast
4	Things made or grown to sell	goods
5	Work done for others	services
6	A catfish farm is in which region?	the Delta
7	A paper mill is likely in which region?	the Piney Woods
8	A tour guide provides a...	service
9	Lumber is a...	good

#	Question	Answer
10	Trace a product (cotton T-shirt or shrimp dinner) from resource to you. Name at least three producers.	Answers vary.
11	How does a region's land affect its economy? Give one example.	e.g. Delta soil supports farming jobs.

UNIT REVIEW · ANSWER KEY
Study before the unit test

About 40 minutes

Unit 1 Review — Answer Key

Homework or a study session before the test.

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Four map parts	title, compass rose, key, scale
2	Lines that run east–west	latitude
3	Mississippi borders Tennessee to the…	north
4	the Delta	flat, fertile, crops
5	Piney Woods	pine forests, timber
6	Gulf Coast	seafood, shipbuilding, tourism
7	oil: renewable?	no
8	forests: renewable?	yes
9	a doctor's checkup: good or service?	service

UNIT TEST · ANSWER KEY
At the end of the unit
About 45 minutes

Unit 1 Test — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Which map part tells what symbols mean?	map key (legend)
2	Which direction is between south and west?	southwest
3	Use the map's scale. About how far is Jackson from Gulfport? (figure)	about 150 miles (accept 130–170)
4	Which coordinates are closest to Jackson? A. 32° N, 90° W B. 32° S, 90° E C. 90° N, 32° W	A. 32° N, 90° W
5	Name the states that border Mississippi.	Tennessee, Alabama, Louisiana, Arkansas
6	What body of water is on Mississippi's southern coast?	Gulf of Mexico
7	Why do most rivers in Mississippi flow south?	The land slopes down from north to south.
8	Which kind of map would best show county boundaries? A. physical B. political C. elevation	B. political
9	Which region has rich alluvial soil?	the Delta
10	Which region is known for pine forests?	Piney Woods
11	Name one Gulf Coast job.	e.g. shrimper, shipbuilder, tour guide
12	Which is a nonrenewable resource? A. timber B. natural gas C. catfish	B. natural gas
13	Goods or service: delivering mail	service
14	Name one way to conserve a natural resource.	e.g. replant trees, recycle, fishing limits
15	Choose two Mississippi regions. Compare their land and explain how the land affects the work people do there.	Rubric: two regions correctly described (1); one similarity (1); one difference (1); clear link between land/resources and jobs (1).

Scoring

Score	What it means / next step
16–18 (85%+)	Mastered.

Score	What it means / next step
13–15	Proficient; review missed skills.
Below 13	Reteach and retest.

UNIT 2 · TEACHER OVERVIEW

Mississippi's People: Past and Present

Communities and cultures today, the first peoples, American Indian nations, European explorers, statehood and removal, and settlement patterns.

Long before Mississippi was a state, people built towns, farmed, and raised great mounds here. In this unit you'll meet the people of Mississippi today and in the past: the first peoples and mound builders, the Choctaw, Chickasaw, and Natchez nations, the Spanish and French explorers, and the settlers who arrived when Mississippi became a state. You'll also discover why towns grew where they did.

Big ideas

- Describe urban, suburban, and rural communities and Mississippi's cultures.
- Explain how the first peoples and American Indian nations lived.
- Explain how European arrival, statehood, and removal changed Mississippi.
- Explain how rivers, railroads, and roads shaped settlement.

Standards

Code	Standard
C3 D2.His.1–3, 14	Change, continuity, and context; causes and effects.
C3 D2.Geo.4–7	Human–environment interaction; movement and settlement.

What students should already know

- Map skills and Mississippi's regions (Unit 1).

Materials for the unit

- Blank outline maps of Mississippi
- Paper strips for timelines
- Colored pencils and markers

- A pan of sand and small objects for the dig

Pacing guide

Teach the lessons in order, then give the week's check. Set the days to fit your own calendar.

Week	Order	Lesson	Title
Week 1	Lesson 1 of 2	2.1	Communities: Urban, Suburban, and Rural
Week 1	Lesson 2 of 2	2.2	Mississippi's Cultures and Traditions
Week 1	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 1: Communities and Cultures
Week 2	Lesson 1 of 2	2.3	The First Peoples and the Mound Builders
Week 2	Lesson 2 of 2	2.4	The Choctaw
Week 2	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 2: The First Peoples
Week 3	Lesson 1 of 2	2.5	The Chickasaw and the Natchez
Week 3	Lesson 2 of 2	2.6	Europeans Arrive
Week 3	End of week	Check	Weekly Check 3: Nations and Explorers
Week 4	Lesson 1 of 2	2.7	Statehood and Indian Removal
Week 4	Lesson 2 of 2	2.8	Settlement Patterns: Why People Live Where They Do
Week 4	Before the test	Review	Unit 2 Review
Week 4	End of unit	Test	Unit 2 Test

TEACHING THIS UNIT AT HOME

Visit a Mississippi mound site, a Blues Trail marker, or the Museum of Mississippi History in Jackson, and talk about whose story the place tells.

UNIT VOCABULARY

culture	A group's way of life.
artifact	An object made by people long ago.
nation	A group with its own land, government, and way of life.
treaty	A written agreement between nations.
territory	Land that is not yet a state.
settlement pattern	How towns are spread across the land.

LESSON 2.1 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 1 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: Mississippi's People: Past and Present

Lesson 2.1: Communities: Urban, Suburban, and Rural

Student goal	I can describe urban, suburban, and rural communities in Mississippi and explain how they differ.
Objective	Students describe urban, suburban, and rural communities.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.5.3-5, D2.Geo.7.3-5 — Explain how human settlements and movements relate to the locations and use of resources.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 1, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 2.1
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Traffic or birds?
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and chart.
Analyze	10	Compare the three community types. Model the clue example.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking rural areas are unimportant or empty.

SUPPORT

- Picture sort of the three community types.

EXTEND

- Find your county's population online.

STUDENT LESSON 2.1 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.1: Communities: Urban, Suburban, and Rural

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.1 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Community Survey.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.1 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

Think of the town where you live. Do you hear more traffic or more birds outside your window? What does that tell you about your community?

Almost 3 million people live in Mississippi. They live in many kinds of communities. Some live in urban areas, or cities, with tall buildings, busy streets, and many neighbors close by. Others live in suburban areas just outside a city, with neighborhoods, schools, and shopping centers. Many Mississippians live in rural areas, where homes are spread out among farms, forests, and small towns.

	Urban	Suburban	Rural
what it looks like	tall buildings, busy streets	neighborhoods, shopping centers	farms, forests, small towns
how close neighbors are	very close	fairly close	far apart
how people get around	cars, buses, walking	mostly cars	cars and trucks; long drives
Mississippi example	Jackson	Madison or Southaven	a Delta farm town

Jackson, the state capital, is Mississippi's largest city, with about 150,000 people. Other large cities include Gulfport, Southaven, Biloxi, and Hattiesburg. Even so, a large share of Mississippians live in rural areas, more than in most other states.

LOOK CLOSER · USE CLUES TO NAME A COMMUNITY

Kayla rides a school bus 30 minutes past cotton fields to get to school. Her nearest neighbor lives a mile away.

1 Clue: a long ride past fields.

2 Clue: neighbors live far apart.

3 Both clues match the rural column of the chart.

Answer: Kayla lives in a rural community.

ACTIVITY · COMMUNITY SURVEY

What kind of community do you live in?

You need: paper and a pencil; a family member to interview.

1 Count how many houses you can see from your front door.

2 Time how long it takes to drive to the nearest grocery store.

3 Ask a family member what jobs people in your community do.

4 Use your answers and the chart to decide: urban, suburban, or rural?

Record: your three answers and a sentence that names your community type with two reasons.

! WATCH OUT

Rural does not mean empty or unimportant. Rural communities grow much of the food, timber, and cotton the whole state and country depend on.

★ KEY IDEA

Urban communities are cities, suburban communities are near cities, and rural communities are in the countryside. Mississippi has all three.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Which kind of community has the most people living close together?

Answer: urban

2. What is Mississippi's largest city?

Answer: Jackson

3. Name one thing you might see in a rural community.

Answer: e.g. farms, forests, fields, small towns

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.1

#	Question	Answer
1	Which kind of community has the most people living close together?	urban
2	What is Mississippi's largest city?	Jackson
3	Name one thing you might see in a rural community.	e.g. farms, forests, fields, small towns
4	The number of people in a place	population
5	A community near a city	suburban
6	a downtown apartment building	urban
7	a soybean farm	rural
8	a neighborhood with a playground just outside Jackson	suburban
9	a busy city bus stop	urban
10	a long gravel road through the woods	rural
11	a shopping center near the interstate outside a city	suburban
12	What kind of community do you live in? Give two clues from your Community Survey.	Answers vary; two clues that match the community type.

LESSON 2.2 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 1 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 2: Mississippi's People: Past and Present

Lesson 2.2: Mississippi's Cultures and Traditions

Student goal	I can describe music, food, and traditions that are part of Mississippi's culture.
Objective	Students describe parts of Mississippi's culture.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.6.3-5, D2.His.2.3-5 — Explain how culture influences the way people live; describe connections between historical events and developments.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 1, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Workbook Lesson 2.2
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	A family tradition.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and culture chart.
Analyze	10	Play a short blues or gospel recording. Model the interview questions.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking culture means only art and music.

SUPPORT

- Culture web graphic organizer.

EXTEND

- Explore the Mississippi Blues Trail map online.

STUDENT LESSON 2.2 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.2: Mississippi's Cultures and Traditions

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.2 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Family Heritage Interview.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.2 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

What is one food, song, or holiday tradition your family shares every year? Who taught it to you?

Culture is a group's way of life: the food they cook, the music they play, the stories they tell, and the holidays they celebrate. Mississippi's culture mixes traditions from American Indian nations, African Americans, people of European background, and newer neighbors from around the world.

Mississippi is famous for its music. The blues grew in the Delta from the work songs and spirituals of Black Mississippians. Blues musicians such as B.B. King carried it around the world. Elvis Presley was born in Tupelo, and gospel and country music are loved across the state. Markers on the Mississippi Blues Trail tell where blues history happened.

Part of culture	Mississippi examples
music	blues, gospel, country, rock and roll
food	fried catfish, Gulf shrimp and gumbo, Delta hot tamales, sweet potato pie
writers	Eudora Welty of Jackson and William Faulkner of Oxford
celebrations	the Choctaw Indian Fair, Mardi Gras on the Gulf Coast, county fairs, family reunions

ACTIVITY · FAMILY HERITAGE INTERVIEW

What traditions has your family passed down?

You need: paper and a pencil; an older family member to interview.

1 Ask: What is a tradition our family has had for a long time?

2 Ask: Who started it, and where?

3 Ask: What food, song, or story goes with it?

4 Draw a picture of the tradition.

Record: the answers to your three questions and your drawing.

★ KEY IDEA

Culture is a group's way of life. Mississippi's culture includes the blues, gospel, Gulf seafood, great writers, and traditions from many groups of people.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Where in Mississippi did the blues grow?

Answer: the Delta

2. Name a Mississippi musician.

Answer: e.g. B.B. King or Elvis Presley

3. What is a tradition?

Answer: something people do the same way for many years and pass down

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.2

#	Question	Answer
1	Where in Mississippi did the blues grow?	the Delta
2	Name a Mississippi musician.	e.g. B.B. King or Elvis Presley
3	What is a tradition?	something people do the same way for many years and pass down
4	A group's way of life	culture
5	History handed down from earlier generations	heritage
6	Name two foods that are part of Mississippi's culture.	e.g. catfish, Gulf shrimp, gumbo, hot tamales
7	Which Mississippi city is Elvis Presley's birthplace?	Tupelo
8	What do Blues Trail markers show?	where blues history happened
9	Name a Mississippi writer.	Eudora Welty or William Faulkner
10	Describe one tradition from your Family Heritage Interview. Who passed it down?	Answers vary.

#	Question	Answer
11	Why do you think people work to keep traditions alive?	e.g. to remember where they came from and to share it with the next generation.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 2.2

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 1: Communities and Cultures — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	A community in the countryside	rural
2	A community near a city	suburban
3	Mississippi's largest city	Jackson
4	Music that grew in the Delta	the blues
5	Something passed down for many years	a tradition
6	Name two parts of Mississippi's culture.	e.g. the blues, gospel, catfish, Gulf seafood, the Choctaw Indian Fair, Eudora Welty.

LESSON 2.3 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 2 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: Mississippi's People: Past and Present

Lesson 2.3: The First Peoples and the Mound Builders

Student goal	I can describe how the first people in Mississippi lived and why they built mounds.
Objective	Students describe early peoples and the mound builders.
Standard	C3 D2.His.2.3-5, D2.Geo.4.3-5 — Compare life in specific historical time periods to life today.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 2, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Sand box, buried objects, spoon, brush, workbook Lesson 2.3
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	A backpack in 1,000 years.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and timeline chart.
Analyze	10	Discuss artifacts and oral history. Locate mound sites on a map.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking all early peoples lived the same way at the same time.

SUPPORT

- Timeline strip with pictures.

EXTEND

- Visit Emerald Mound or Winterville Mounds, or explore them online.

STUDENT LESSON 2.3 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.3: The First Peoples and the Mound Builders

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.3 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Be an Archaeologist.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.3 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

If someone found your backpack 1,000 years from now, what would it tell them about you?

People have lived in what is now Mississippi for more than 12,000 years. The first people were hunters who followed large animals. Over thousands of years, people learned to gather nuts and plants, make pottery, and use bows and arrows. Later they farmed corn, beans, and squash.

We know about these people from artifacts, such as spear points, pottery pieces, and tools, that archaeologists dig up and study. American Indian nations also keep their history alive through stories passed down for many generations.

Time	How people lived
more than 12,000 years ago	hunted large animals with stone-tipped spears; moved often
about 10,000–3,000 years ago	hunted deer, fished, and gathered nuts and plants; made tools and the first pottery
about 3,000–1,200 years ago	made more pottery; used bows and arrows; began building mounds; grew some plants
about 1,200–400 years ago	farmed corn in large towns; built tall flat-topped mounds for leaders and ceremonies

The Mississippian people built some of the largest earthworks in North America. Emerald Mound, near Natchez, covers about eight acres and is one of the largest mounds in the United States. Winterville Mounds, near Greenville, was a major ceremonial center. The Choctaw honor Nanih Waiya, a mound in Winston County, as the place where their people began.

ACTIVITY · BE AN ARCHAEOLOGIST

What can artifacts tell us about people?

You need: a shoebox or pan of sand or dirt; five small household objects buried by your teacher; a spoon and a paintbrush; paper.

1 Dig slowly with the spoon and brush, the way archaeologists do.

2 Draw each artifact where you found it.

3 Write what each artifact might have been used for.

4 Make an inference about the person who used them.

Record: your drawings and an inference that uses at least two artifacts as evidence.

★ KEY IDEA

The first peoples of Mississippi hunted, gathered, and later farmed. The Mississippian people built great mounds, such as Emerald Mound, for leaders and ceremonies.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. How long have people lived in what is now Mississippi?

Answer: more than 12,000 years

2. What does an archaeologist study?

Answer: artifacts, to learn about the past

3. Name a mound site in Mississippi.

Answer: Emerald Mound, Winterville Mounds, or Nanih Waiya

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.3

#	Question	Answer
1	How long have people lived in what is now Mississippi?	more than 12,000 years
2	What does an archaeologist study?	artifacts, to learn about the past
3	Name a mound site in Mississippi.	Emerald Mound, Winterville Mounds, or Nanih Waiya
4	An object made by people long ago	artifact
5	The time before written history	prehistory
6	Which three crops did later peoples farm?	corn, beans, and squash
7	Which mound is near Natchez?	Emerald Mound

#	Question	Answer
8	Which mound site is near Greenville?	Winterville Mounds
9	Which mound do the Choctaw honor as where their people began?	Nanih Waiya
10	How did life change when people began to farm?	They could stay in one place, build towns, and grow more food.
11	Why are artifacts important for learning about prehistory?	There are no written records, so objects are evidence of how people lived.

LESSON 2.4 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 2 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: Mississippi's People: Past and Present

Lesson 2.4: The Choctaw

Student goal	I can describe the land, homes, food, and traditions of the Choctaw people.
Objective	Students describe Choctaw life and culture past and present.
Standard	C3 D2.His.2.3-5, D2.Geo.6.3-5 — Compare life in historical time periods to life today; explain how culture shapes ways of life.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 2, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Paper, colored pencils, workbook Lesson 2.4
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Needs before stores.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson.
Analyze	10	Explain the Three Sisters. Stress that the Choctaw are a living nation today.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Speaking of American Indians only in the past tense.

SUPPORT

- Needs chart: food, shelter, clothing, fun.

EXTEND

- Watch a video of stickball at the Choctaw Indian Fair.

STUDENT LESSON 2.4 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.4: The Choctaw

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.4 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Three Sisters Diagram.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.4 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

What do you think a family needed to live well in Mississippi long before stores and electricity?

When Europeans arrived, the Choctaw were the largest American Indian nation in what is now Mississippi. They lived in towns across the central and southern parts of the state. Choctaw families belonged to clans, and children belonged to their mother's clan.

The Choctaw were skilled farmers. They planted the Three Sisters together: corn stalks gave beans a pole to climb, beans made the soil richer, and wide squash leaves shaded out weeds. They also hunted deer, fished in rivers, and gathered nuts and berries. Homes were made of wooden poles covered with mud and grass.

Stickball was a favorite game. Teams used two sticks to catch and throw a small ball, and games could include hundreds of players. The Choctaw called it the “little brother of war” because it was so rough. Stickball is still played today.

Need	How the Choctaw met it
food	the Three Sisters, deer, fish, nuts, berries
shelter	homes of poles, mud, and grass
clothing	deerskin, and later woven cloth
fun and community	stickball, dances, storytelling

Many Choctaw were later forced to leave Mississippi (you'll learn about this in Lesson 2.7), but some stayed. Today the Mississippi Band of Choctaw Indians has its own government near Philadelphia, in Neshoba County. Every summer, the Choctaw Indian Fair features stickball, traditional dances, and food.

ACTIVITY · THREE SISTERS DIAGRAM

How do corn, beans, and squash help each other?

You need: paper; colored pencils.

1 Draw a corn stalk in the middle of a garden mound.

2 Draw a bean vine climbing the corn.

3 Draw squash leaves spreading on the ground.

4 Label each plant with how it helps the others.

Record: your labeled diagram.

★ KEY IDEA

The Choctaw farmed the Three Sisters, hunted, and played stickball. The Mississippi Band of Choctaw Indians still lives in Mississippi today.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. What are the Three Sisters?

Answer: corn, beans, and squash

2. Which clan did a Choctaw child belong to?

Answer: their mother's clan

3. Where does the Mississippi Band of Choctaw Indians have its government today?

Answer: near Philadelphia, in Neshoba County

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.4

#	Question	Answer
1	What are the Three Sisters?	corn, beans, and squash
2	Which clan did a Choctaw child belong to?	their mother's clan
3	Where does the Mississippi Band of Choctaw Indians have its government today?	near Philadelphia, in Neshoba County
4	A large group of related families	clan
5	A group with its own land and government	nation
6	How did corn help beans?	It gave the beans a pole to climb.
7	How did squash help the garden?	Its leaves shaded out weeds.
8	What were Choctaw homes made of?	wooden poles covered with mud and grass

#	Question	Answer
9	Why was stickball called the “little brother of war”?	It was very rough.
10	Compare how the Choctaw met one need (food, shelter, or fun) with how your family meets it today.	Answers vary; one Choctaw way and one modern way.
11	Name two ways the Choctaw used the land and its resources.	e.g. farming the Three Sisters; hunting deer; fishing; building homes from poles and grass.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 2.4

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 2: The First Peoples — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	A scientist who studies artifacts	archaeologist
2	A large mound near Natchez	Emerald Mound
3	The Three Sisters	corn, beans, and squash
4	The largest nation in Mississippi when Europeans arrived	the Choctaw
5	A Choctaw team game	stickball
6	How do we learn about people who lived before written history?	From artifacts that archaeologists study and from stories passed down.

LESSON 2.5 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 3 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: Mississippi's People: Past and Present

Lesson 2.5: The Chickasaw and the Natchez

Student goal	I can compare the Chickasaw and the Natchez and locate where each nation lived.
Objective	Students compare the Chickasaw and Natchez.
Standard	C3 D2.His.2.3-5, D2.Geo.2.3-5 — Compare life in specific historical periods; use maps to explain locations of places.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 3, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Outline maps, colored pencils, workbook Lesson 2.5
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Location shapes life.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson; study the map.
Analyze	10	Model the comparison chart.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking all American Indian nations were the same.

SUPPORT

- Two-column compare chart.

EXTEND

- Visit the Grand Village of the Natchez Indians site online.

STUDENT LESSON 2.5 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.5: The Chickasaw and the Natchez

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.5 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Nations Map.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.5, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.5 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

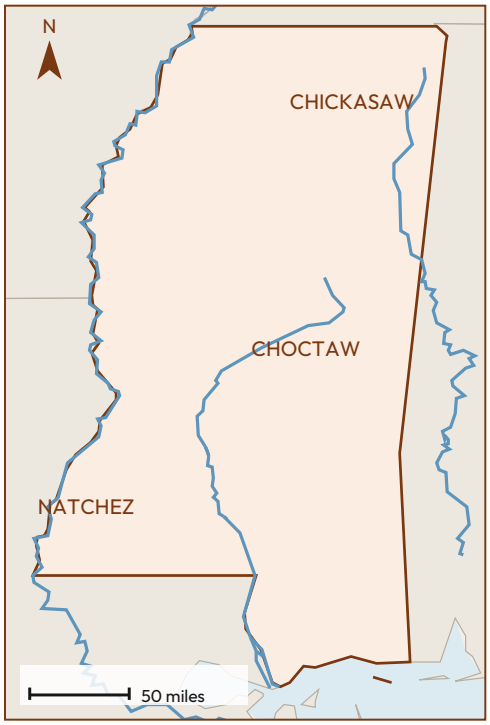
Two nations lived in very different parts of Mississippi. How might where they lived change how they lived?

The Chickasaw lived in the hills of northeastern Mississippi, near where Tupelo is today. They were farmers and hunters known as brave defenders of their land.

In 1736, Chickasaw warriors defeated a French army at the Battle of Ackia, near Tupelo.

The Natchez lived along the Mississippi River in the southwest. Their leader, the Great Sun, lived on top of a mound at the Grand Village.

Nations around 1700



Approximate homelands; borders changed over time.

The Natchez had strict social classes, and the Great Sun was treated almost like a god. When French settlers took more and more Natchez land, the Natchez fought back in 1729. The French and their allies then attacked the Natchez, and by 1731 the Natchez had to leave their homeland. Many survivors joined the Chickasaw, Creek, and Cherokee nations.

	Chickasaw	Natchez
where they lived	hills of northeastern Mississippi	along the Mississippi River in the southwest
leaders	chiefs and councils	the Great Sun
known for	defending their land; defeating the French in 1736	the Grand Village and its mounds
what happened	forced to move west in the 1830s (Lesson 2.7)	scattered by war with the French by 1731

ACTIVITY · NATIONS MAP

Where did each nation live?

You need: a blank outline map of Mississippi; three colored pencils.

1 Shade the Chickasaw homeland in the northeast.

2 Shade the Choctaw homeland in the center and south.

3 Shade the Natchez homeland along the river in the southwest.

4 Add a key and a title.

Record: your finished map with a key and title.

★ KEY IDEA

The Chickasaw lived in the northeast and defended their land fiercely. The Natchez lived along the Mississippi River and were led by the Great Sun.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Where did the Chickasaw live?

Answer: the hills of northeastern Mississippi

2. What was the title of the Natchez leader?

Answer: the Great Sun

3. Which nation defeated the French at the Battle of Ackia in 1736?

Answer: the Chickasaw

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.5

#	Question	Answer
1	Where did the Chickasaw live?	the hills of northeastern Mississippi
2	What was the title of the Natchez leader?	the Great Sun
3	Which nation defeated the French at the Battle of Ackia in 1736?	the Chickasaw
4	To tell how things are alike and different	compare
5	The Natchez ceremonial town	the Grand Village
6	Which nation lived along the Mississippi River?	the Natchez
7	Which nation lived near present-day Tupelo?	the Chickasaw
8	Which nation had strict social classes?	the Natchez
9	Which nations did many Natchez survivors join?	the Chickasaw, Creek, and Cherokee
10	Tell one way the Chickasaw and Natchez were alike and one way they were different.	e.g. Alike: both American Indian nations in Mississippi who farmed. Different: the Natchez had one powerful leader, the Great Sun.
11	Why did the Natchez fight the French in 1729?	French settlers kept taking more Natchez land.

LESSON 2.6 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 3 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: Mississippi's People: Past and Present

Lesson 2.6: Europeans Arrive

Student goal	I can explain when and why Europeans came to Mississippi and how their arrival changed life for American Indians.
Objective	Students explain European exploration and its effects.
Standard	C3 D2.His.1.3-5, D2.His.14.3-5 — Create and use a chronological sequence of events; explain the effects of events on people.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 3, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Paper strips, markers, workbook Lesson 2.6
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Strangers arrive.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and timeline.
Analyze	10	Build a class timeline. Discuss point of view: explorers vs American Indian nations.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook. The Weekly Check comes next.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Saying Europeans “discovered” a land where people already lived.

SUPPORT

- Timeline cards to order.

EXTEND

- Find Ocean Springs and Natchez on a map.

STUDENT LESSON 2.6 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.6: Europeans Arrive

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.6 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Timeline Strip.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.6 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

Imagine strangers arrive in your town with animals, tools, and diseases you've never seen. What might change?

The first Europeans in Mississippi were Spanish. In 1540–1541, Hernando de Soto led an expedition of soldiers through the region looking for gold. They fought with American Indian nations and, in 1541, became the first Europeans known to see the Mississippi River. They found no gold.

The Spanish also brought diseases, such as smallpox, that American Indians had never had. Their bodies had no protection, so the diseases spread quickly and many thousands of people died.

Next came the French. In 1682, René-Robert Cavelier, Sieur de La Salle traveled down the Mississippi River and claimed the whole river valley for France, naming it Louisiana. In 1699, Pierre Le Moyne d'Iberville built Fort Maurepas, at today's Ocean Springs, the first European settlement in Mississippi. The French traded with American Indians and brought enslaved Africans to work on farms.

Year	Event
1540–1541	Hernando de Soto's Spanish expedition crosses the region and reaches the Mississippi River.
1682	La Salle claims the Mississippi River valley for France.
1699	Iberville builds Fort Maurepas at Ocean Springs.
1716	The French build Fort Rosalie at Natchez.
1763	France loses a war and gives the land to Great Britain.

ACTIVITY · TIMELINE STRIP

In what order did these events happen?

You need: a long strip of paper; a ruler; markers.

1 Draw a line across the strip and mark years from 1500 to 1800.

2 Add each event from the chart at the right place.

3 Draw a small picture for each event.

4 Circle the event you think changed life most for American Indians and explain why.

Record: your timeline and a sentence explaining your circled event.

! WATCH OUT

When Europeans "claimed" land, American Indian nations were already living on it. The land was their home long before any European arrived.

★ KEY IDEA

Spanish explorers came first, bringing war and disease. The French claimed the river valley, built forts, and traded. Europeans' arrival changed American Indian life forever.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Who led the first Spanish expedition through Mississippi?

Answer: Hernando de Soto

2. What did Iberville build in 1699?

Answer: Fort Maurepas, at Ocean Springs

3. Why did European diseases spread so quickly among American Indians?

Answer: They had never had them, so their bodies had no protection.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.6

#	Question	Answer
1	Who led the first Spanish expedition through Mississippi?	Hernando de Soto
2	What did Iberville build in 1699?	Fort Maurepas, at Ocean Springs
3	Why did European diseases spread so quickly among American Indians?	They had never had them, so their bodies had no protection.
4	A place ruled by a faraway country	colony
5	A long journey made for a purpose	expedition

#	Question	Answer
6	What was de Soto looking for?	gold
7	Which country did La Salle claim the river valley for?	France
8	What did La Salle name the land?	Louisiana
9	Which came first: Fort Maurepas or Fort Rosalie?	Fort Maurepas (1699)
10	Describe two ways the arrival of Europeans changed life for American Indians.	e.g. diseases killed many people; Europeans took land; trade brought new goods.
11	Why does the Watch Out say American Indians were already living on the land Europeans claimed? Why does that matter?	The land was already their home; a claim by Europeans ignored them.

WEEKLY CHECK · ANSWER KEY
After Lesson 2.6

About 15 minutes

Weekly Check 3: Nations and Explorers — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Nation that lived near present-day Tupelo	the Chickasaw
2	Leader of the Natchez	the Great Sun
3	Spanish explorer who reached the Mississippi River in 1541	Hernando de Soto
4	First European settlement in Mississippi (1699)	Fort Maurepas
5	Country La Salle claimed the river valley for	France
6	Name one way the arrival of Europeans harmed American Indians.	e.g. diseases killed many people; Europeans took their land.

LESSON 2.7 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 4 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: Mississippi's People: Past and Present

Lesson 2.7: Statehood and Indian Removal

Student goal	I can explain how Mississippi became a state and how American Indian nations were forced to leave.
Objective	Students explain statehood, removal, and slavery in early Mississippi.
Standard	C3 D2.His.2.3-5, D2.Civ.2.3-5 — Explain probable causes and effects of events; compare perspectives.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 4, lesson 1 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Paper, workbook Lesson 2.7
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Leaving home.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson carefully together.
Analyze	10	Discuss treaties and forced removal honestly and with care. Model one point of view.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook lesson pages: Warm-Up through Exit Ticket.
Exit Ticket	3	Student completes the Exit Ticket alone. Check it before the next lesson.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking all American Indians left Mississippi.

SUPPORT

- Point-of-view sentence frames.

EXTEND

- Read about the Choctaw Nation of Oklahoma and the Mississippi Band of Choctaw Indians today.

STUDENT LESSON 2.7 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.7: Statehood and Indian Removal

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.7 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Points of View.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.7, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.7 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

How would you feel if you were told you had to leave your home and move hundreds of miles away?

After the American Revolution, the land that is now Mississippi became part of the United States. In 1798, it became the Mississippi Territory. More settlers came, and on December 10, 1817, Mississippi became the 20th state. In 1822, the capital moved to Jackson, near the center of the state.

Settlers wanted the rich land of the Choctaw and Chickasaw to grow cotton. The United States government pressured the nations to sign treaties giving up their land. In the Treaty of Dancing Rabbit Creek (1830), the Choctaw gave up their last land in Mississippi. In 1832, the Chickasaw signed the Treaty of Pontotoc Creek.

Thousands of Choctaw and Chickasaw were forced to walk or travel hundreds of miles west to Indian Territory, in what is now Oklahoma. Many died of cold, hunger, and sickness on the way. This sad journey is part of what is called the Trail of Tears. Some Choctaw stayed in Mississippi, and their descendants are the Mississippi Band of Choctaw Indians.

Cotton farms called plantations grew huge, and they depended on the work of enslaved African Americans. By 1860, more than half of the people in Mississippi were enslaved. Enslaved people built much of Mississippi's wealth but were denied their freedom, their pay, and often their families.

Year	Event
1798	The Mississippi Territory is created.
1817	Mississippi becomes the 20th state (December 10).
1822	The capital moves to Jackson.
1830	Choctaw land is given up in the Treaty of Dancing Rabbit Creek.
1832	Chickasaw land is given up in the Treaty of Pontotoc Creek.

ACTIVITY · POINTS OF VIEW

How did people see the same event differently?

You need: paper folded into three columns; a pencil.

1 Label the columns: a cotton settler, a Choctaw family, an enslaved person.

2 In each column, write what that person wanted or hoped for in the 1830s.

3 Write how the events of this lesson affected each person.

4 Talk with your teacher about why points of view are different.

Record: your three-column chart.

★ KEY IDEA

Mississippi became the 20th state in 1817. Treaties forced the Choctaw and Chickasaw to give up their land and move west, and cotton plantations depended on enslaved people.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. When did Mississippi become a state?

Answer: December 10, 1817 (the 20th state)

2. Which treaty took the Choctaw's last land in Mississippi?

Answer: the Treaty of Dancing Rabbit Creek (1830)

3. Where were the Choctaw and Chickasaw forced to move?

Answer: Indian Territory, now Oklahoma

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.7

#	Question	Answer
1	When did Mississippi become a state?	December 10, 1817 (the 20th state)
2	Which treaty took the Choctaw's last land in Mississippi?	the Treaty of Dancing Rabbit Creek (1830)
3	Where were the Choctaw and Chickasaw forced to move?	Indian Territory, now Oklahoma
4	A written agreement between nations	treaty
5	Land that is not yet a state	territory
6	Mississippi was which number state?	the 20th
7	Why did the capital move to Jackson?	It is near the center of the state.
8	Which crop made settlers want more land?	cotton
9	Which treaty did the Chickasaw sign in 1832?	the Treaty of Pontotoc Creek
10	Explain why some Choctaw families still live in Mississippi today.	Some Choctaw stayed when others were forced west; their descendants are the Mississippi Band of Choctaw Indians.
11	Choose one point of view from your chart. How did the events of the 1830s affect that person?	Answers vary; must match the point of view.

LESSON 2.8 · TEACHER PLAN
Week 4 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: Mississippi's People: Past and Present

Lesson 2.8: Settlement Patterns: Why People Live Where They Do

Student goal	I can explain how rivers, soil, railroads, and roads shaped where Mississippi's towns and cities grew.
Objective	Students explain settlement patterns.
Standard	C3 D2.Geo.4.3-5, D2.Geo.7.3-5 — Explain how human settlements relate to locations and resources.
Pacing	Unit 2, week 4, lesson 2 of 2
Time	About 50 minutes
Materials	Large paper, markers, workbook Lesson 2.8, Unit 2 Review
Get ready	Read the student lesson and its sources, preview the maps, and answer the Check Your Understanding questions.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Warm-Up	5	Starting a new town.
Read and Discuss	15	Read the lesson and chart.
Analyze	10	Model explaining Gulfport's location.
Guided Practice	7	Check Your Understanding 1–3.
Independent	10	Workbook; then the Unit 2 Review.
Exit Ticket	3	Next: Unit 2 Test.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Thinking towns are placed randomly.

SUPPORT

- Reason cards: water, land, travel, trade.

EXTEND

- Find when your town was founded and why.

STUDENT LESSON 2.8 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 2.8: Settlement Patterns: Why People Live Where They Do

STUDENT'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.8 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Activity activity: Build a Town.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.8 (Parts B–D).

THINK ABOUT IT

If you were starting a new town 200 years ago, where would you build it? What would you need nearby?

Towns don't grow just anywhere. People choose places with what they need: water, good land, and ways to travel and trade. The way towns are spread across the land is called a settlement pattern.

Reason	Why people settled there	Mississippi examples
rivers	water, fish, and boat travel for trade	Natchez and Vicksburg on the Mississippi River
the Gulf	ports for ships; seafood	Biloxi, Gulfport, Pascagoula
rich soil	farming	Delta towns such as Greenville and Clarksdale
railroads (1800s)	trains carried lumber and cotton to market	Hattiesburg and Meridian grew as railroad towns
highways (1900s–today)	cars and trucks move people and goods	Southaven and towns along I-55 and I-20

Early towns grew beside rivers because boats were the easiest way to move goods. In the late 1800s, railroads crossed the state, and new towns sprang up along the tracks. Today, many people live near interstate highways and the suburbs around cities like Jackson and Memphis.

LOOK CLOSER · EXPLAIN A CITY'S LOCATION

Why did Gulfport grow where it did?

1 Look at the map: Gulfport is on the Gulf of Mexico.

2 A port lets ships load lumber and other goods.

3 A railroad brought lumber from the Piney Woods to the port.

Answer: Gulfport grew where a railroad met the Gulf, so goods could move from trains to ships.

ACTIVITY · BUILD A TOWN

Where is the best place to start a town?

You need: a large sheet of paper; markers.

1 Draw a river, a coast, a forest, and a flat field.

2 Choose a spot for your town and draw it.

3 Add a road or railroad that connects your town to another place.

4 Write three reasons you chose that spot.

Record: your town map and three reasons.

★ KEY IDEA

People settle where they can find water, good land, and ways to travel and trade. Rivers, the Gulf, railroads, and highways shaped where Mississippi's towns grew.

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in color.

1. Why did early towns grow beside rivers?

Answer: Boats were the easiest way to move goods; rivers gave water and fish.

2. Name a Mississippi town that grew because of the railroad.

Answer: Hattiesburg or Meridian

3. What is a settlement pattern?

Answer: the way towns and cities are spread across the land

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 2.8

#	Question	Answer
1	Why did early towns grow beside rivers?	Boats were the easiest way to move goods; rivers gave water and fish.
2	Name a Mississippi town that grew because of the railroad.	Hattiesburg or Meridian
3	What is a settlement pattern?	the way towns and cities are spread across the land

#	Question	Answer
4	A town where ships load and unload	port
5	A place where people make a home	settlement
6	Which two river cities are on the Mississippi?	Natchez and Vicksburg
7	Name a Gulf port city.	Biloxi, Gulfport, or Pascagoula
8	What did railroads carry to market?	lumber and cotton
9	What do many people live near today?	interstate highways and suburbs
10	Choose your town or the nearest city. Explain one reason it grew where it did.	Answers vary; a reason tied to water, land, railroad, or highway.
11	Would you rather start a town by a river or by a railroad? Explain.	Answers vary; a reason tied to travel, trade, or resources.

UNIT REVIEW · ANSWER KEY
Study before the unit test

About 40 minutes

Unit 2 Review — Answer Key

Homework or a study session before the test.

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	urban	in a city
2	rural	in the countryside
3	culture	a group's way of life
4	artifact	an object made by people long ago
5	treaty	a written agreement between nations
6	settlement pattern	how towns are spread across the land
7	Year Mississippi became a state	1817
8	Treaty of 1830 that took Choctaw land	Treaty of Dancing Rabbit Creek
9	A Mississippi railroad town	Hattiesburg or Meridian
10	Put in order: statehood, de Soto's expedition, Fort Maurepas, Dancing Rabbit Creek.	de Soto (1540s), Fort Maurepas (1699), statehood (1817), Dancing Rabbit Creek (1830)

UNIT TEST · ANSWER KEY
At the end of the unit
About 45 minutes

Unit 2 Test — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Which kind of community has homes far apart among farms and forests? A. urban B. suburban C. rural	C. rural
2	What is Mississippi's largest city?	Jackson
3	What kind of music grew in the Delta?	the blues
4	Culture includes a group's... A. food, music, and traditions B. only its buildings C. only its weather	A. food, music, and traditions
5	Name the Three Sisters crops.	corn, beans, and squash
6	Name a mound site in Mississippi.	Emerald Mound, Winterville Mounds, or Nanih Waiya
7	Which nation lived in the hills of northeastern Mississippi? A. Natchez B. Chickasaw C. Choctaw	B. Chickasaw
8	Who was the Great Sun?	the leader of the Natchez
9	Where does the Mississippi Band of Choctaw Indians live today?	near Philadelphia, in Neshoba County
10	Who led a Spanish expedition through Mississippi in 1540–1541?	Hernando de Soto
11	When did Mississippi become a state? A. 1699 B. 1817 C. 1830	B. 1817
12	What did the Treaty of Dancing Rabbit Creek do?	The Choctaw gave up their last land in Mississippi.
13	Name one reason a town grew where it did.	e.g. a river, the Gulf, rich soil, a railroad, a highway
14	Explain how the arrival of Europeans and American settlers changed life for American Indian nations in Mississippi. Use at least two events from this unit.	Rubric: names two accurate events (1 each); explains an effect of each on American Indians (1 each).

Scoring

Score	What it means / next step
15–17 (85%+)	Mastered.

Score	What it means / next step
12–14	Proficient; review missed skills.
Below 12	Reteach and retest.

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